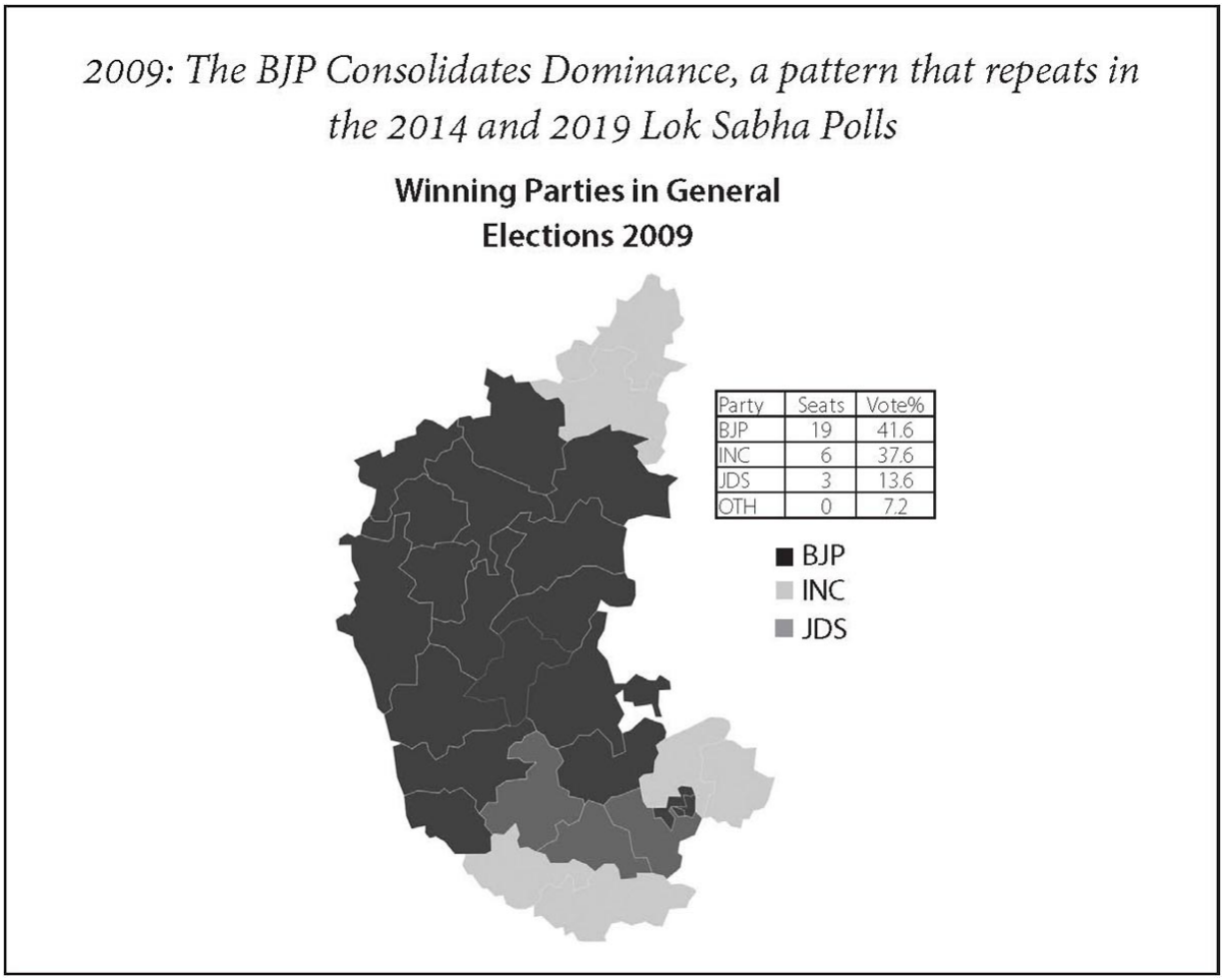
2009: The BJP Consolidates Dominance, a pattern that repeats in the 2014 and 2019 Lok Sabha Polls



Source: ECI data, spatially analysed and visualised by Nalin Mehta, Rishabh Srivastava on https://pollniti.com/#!

B.Y. Vijayendra, the BJP's state vice-president and son of former chief minister Yediyurappa, recalled how his father had laid the foundations of the party. BSY (as Yediyurappa senior is known) went on 'padyatras in the early 1990s which really helped', he says. 'The party grew first in coastal areas, then later in the north … So, our first stage of growth was in urban areas like Bengaluru, the second stage was in coastal areas because of RSS and the third stage was in north Karnataka because of BSY and his padyatras and our outreach to farmers.'[77]

Coastal Karnataka was, so to say, the 'cradle of the Sangh' in Karnataka. As V. Anand puts it, 'There are huge shakhas there and people are deeply committed to RSS there. Tomorrow, say if they give a ticket to me and those guys hate my face, they will say, it's